

Cold call script

Who to call: plumbing, HVAC, roofing, electrical, garage doors, water damage and restoration, towing, pest control. Owner-operator up to about twenty staff. If someone answers the phone on the first ring every time, they are not your customer.

1. Open honestly. Do not pretend to be a customer.

Hi, is this the owner? — My name is ____, I know this is a cold call, can I have thirty seconds and then you can tell me to get lost?

Almost everyone says yes to thirty seconds. Pretending to need a quote gets you a real conversation and then a furious one. Never do it.

2. Two questions. These do the selling, not you.

How many calls would you say you miss in a week? — when you are up a ladder or on a job.

And roughly what is one job worth to you?

Then say the multiplication out loud, slowly, and stop talking. Three calls at four hundred dollars is about five thousand a month. Their number, their mouth, their problem. Silence here is the most powerful thing on the call.

3. Hand them the demo. Do not describe the product.

Do not take my word for any of this. Hang up on me, call 213-682-2616, and tell it your water heater is leaking. That is the thing I am selling. Call me back if it is any good.

This wins more deals than anything you can say. They experience it instead of trusting you. Most people will not hang up — they will put you on speaker and call it while you wait.

4. Price it against a person, never against software.

A receptionist is three grand a month and goes home at five. This is three hundred and ninety nine, and it works nights and weekends. It does not call in sick and it does not quit.

The five objections you will hear

“My customers will hate talking to a robot.”

They hate voicemail more, and voicemail is what they get today. It also says it is an AI in the first sentence, so nobody feels tricked. Ask them: would you rather a machine that books the job, or a voicemail nobody listens to?

“I answer my own phone.”

Agree with them, then aim at the gap. Of course you do — when you can reach it. I am talking about the ones that come in while you are under a sink with the water off.

“Too expensive.”

Answer with their own number from question two. It is less than one job. If it books you one job a month it has paid for itself twice over — and if it does not, cancel it, the first month is guaranteed.

“What if it says the wrong price?”

It can only say prices you typed in. If you have not given it a number it says it does not have pricing and offers a callback. It physically cannot invent one.

“Send me some information.”

Usually a soft no. Take the demo instead: I can, but it will tell you less than ninety seconds on the phone with it. Call 213-682-2616 tonight, and I will call you Thursday morning either way.

5. Close on a small, specific next step.

Let us just switch it on for two weeks. You keep your number, it answers what you miss, and you look at what it booked. If it books you nothing, you cancel and you have lost nothing.

Never close on "think it over". Close on a date and a time you will call back.

6. Voicemail — keep it under fifteen seconds.

Hi, it is _____. I have got something that answers the calls you miss when you are on a job. Do not call me back — call 213-682-2616 and hear it yourself, then decide. I will try you Thursday.

Do not say it pays for itself because it is a tax write-off.

It is deductible like any software, but a deduction is not a refund — at a quarter rate, \$399 really costs about \$300. Any owner with an accountant will catch that and stop believing everything else you said. The honest version is stronger anyway: no payroll tax, no workers comp, no holiday cover, no notice period. Say that instead, and add "your accountant will confirm it is deductible."